

every design decision against your hypothetical representative player to be sure that the decision helps to entertain your target audience.

Defining the platform

Defining the platform might seem a small issue to the novice game designers; but, it is one of the critical decisions. Defining the platform of the game, defines a lot of things in your game. If this is not taken care in the initial changes, you might end up in changing the mechanics of the game itself. The platform decides the UI, game mechanics feasibility, etc...

You have a chance to choose among a variety of platforms like PC, iOS, Mobile, Console, Web etc. While choosing a platform, you should keep in mind the constraints of technology, Cost of development tools, publishing constraints and what gameplay is best for your game and if the platform supports the gameplay well.

The game-world

As already discussed, the game-world/theme defines a lot of things such as game characters and sometimes even the core mechanics of the game. While you choose how your game world will be, keep in mind the following variables:

- ▶ It's dimensions (how large it is, whether it's 2D or 3D)
- ▶ Scale (relative size of objects and characters)
- ▶ Boundaries (bounded, open-ended)
- ▶ Physical Surroundings (buildings, magical items, vehicles)
- ▶ How environment changes with time (what happens if time passes)
- ▶ Level of detail you want to give (real, cartoon-based)

c. Taking care of game-design constraints

Thinking of a game design is easy, but implementing it takes the hell out of people. A Game Designer faces a lot of constraints in turning his game concept into a game which mainly include the following:

- ▶ **Technology constraints:** Difficulties in implementation of the idea, availability of required technology.
- ▶ **Budgetary constraints:** How big is your budget? How much you can put in? What is the approximate budget of the game?
- ▶ **Development time constraints:** What is the desired time frame of completion? How much time you have before the release?